HACK876 × JPS FOUNDATION

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

# Students can be part of something bigger.

The JPS Foundation wants students to dream big about innovation and energy. Hack876 gives secondary students one day to build a working answer to a problem they care about, in teams, with mentors beside them.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

**When:** Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

**Where:** Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

**Who:** About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

**Organisers:** Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers



WHY THE JPS FOUNDATION

The JPS Foundation runs the EcoSpark Innovation Challenge and school Energy Clubs, and names STEM education in its mission.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

**A Gold contribution toward the prizes and the equipment teams build with.**

Gold Partner: J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000. Any amount within the level is welcome.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

Helps support the prizes for the top teams, and equipment for teams building hardware.

WHAT THE JPS FOUNDATION RECEIVES

About 80 students complete a one-day STEM build with mentors beside them. The Foundation receives Gold recognition and a written recap of what was built.

THE NEXT STEP

**A conversation about whether the Foundation would consider supporting the inaugural event, at Gold or any other level, and how it prefers to receive a request. A detailed budget will follow before any formal commitment.**

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com · Book a call: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

# From awareness to action, one build at a time.

**Hack876 is a day where that motivation turns into something students can switch on and show.**

THE JPS FOUNDATION

**"We will empower Jamaicans to be good environmental and community development stewards, through volunteerism, STEM Education, and partnership to contribute to a sustainable and prosperous society"**[2]

Climate resilience, community empowerment and STEM education are the Foundation's three main pillars.[2]

Sophia Lewis: "The future of our country depends on a skilled and innovative workforce. By supporting students in technical disciplines, we are helping to build capacity and create opportunities for the next generation."[3]

Sophia Lewis at the 2026 Climate Action Conference and Expo: "We don't just want you to be aware of the challenges, we want you to be motivated by the solutions."[4]

WHAT THE FOUNDATION ALREADY DOES

2026

### EcoSpark Innovation Challenge

Developed with the Environmental Foundation of Jamaica. Power Up Energy Club finalists and other secondary schools competed in Nature-Based Solutions and Grid Resilience categories, for more than $1.2 million in prizes.[6]

WITH UWI MONA

### CAPE/STEM Workshops

A J$16 million, five-year partnership. Sixth-formers study subjects including computing, physics and chemistry, and more than 1,200 students took part in 2026.[5]

2026

### CSEC Industrial Technology exam fees

Fees covered for more than 300 students across 20 high schools. The programme has now helped over 3,700 students.[3]

2026

### Power Up Scholarships and Mentorship

About $6 million across four categories, with recipients paired with JPS executives for at least three mentoring sessions.[1]

02 OUR REQUEST

# Become a Gold Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

## J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

**GOLD PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876**

The Foundation already funds student prizes through EcoSpark, so contributing toward the Hack876 prizes is a familiar, contained ask. If a smaller first step fits better, a Bronze contribution toward a special award or JPS people on the day would still mean a great deal.

WHAT IT HELPS SUPPORT

- **Prizes.** Contributes toward the prizes for the top teams.
- **Special awards.** Helps support an existing special award.
- **Equipment.** Helps support the equipment teams build with.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

**A detailed event budget will follow before any formal commitment is asked for.**

WHAT THE JPS FOUNDATION WOULD RECEIVE

- **Everything in Silver**
- **More prominent placement on the website and event signage**
- **A dedicated sponsor feature****
- **Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced***
- **A written recap after the event**

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

| Bronze Partner | Silver Partner | Gold Partner SUGGESTED | Platinum Partner |
|---|---|---|---|
| J$50,000 to below J$200,000 | J$200,000 to below J$500,000 | J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000 | J$1,000,000+ |

**In-kind & Community Support:** devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

# A first-year event, with the essentials in place.

| | |
|---|---|
| **ORGANISERS** | Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Georgia Tech) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal. |
| **VENUE** | Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue. |
| **DATE** | Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools. |
| **JUDGES** | 7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp. |
| **THE DAY** | One day, 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM: an opening, a build period with mentors, judging, finals and awards. |

SCHOOL NETWORK AND STATUS

| | |
|---|---|
| Hillel Academy | CONFIRMED |
| Campion College | CONFIRMED |
| Jamaica College | NOT YET CONFIRMED |
| Immaculate Conception High School | NOT YET CONFIRMED |
| Wolmer's | NOT YET CONFIRMED |
| Ardenne High School | IN TALKS |
| American International School of Kingston | NOT YET CONFIRMED |
| St. Andrew High School for Girls | NOT YET CONFIRMED |
| St. George's College | NOT YET CONFIRMED |

2 confirmed, 1 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed. This is the network where the Hack876 team has relationships. It is not a list of confirmed participants, and it is not an exclusive eligibility list.

St. George's College won the People's Choice Award at the 2026 EcoSpark Innovation Challenge for its Rain Garden within a Miniature Sponge City.[6] Status with Hack876: not yet confirmed.

SAFEGUARDS. MANY PARTICIPANTS ARE MINORS.

**Sponsors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day.**

**Mentors and volunteers work in open, supervised spaces.**

**Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.**

**The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship carries no influence over judging and no naming rights.**

# What you would see afterwards, and what we need from you now.

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ How many students, teams and schools took part
- ✓ What the teams built, with the finalist projects described
- ✓ How your contribution was used
- ✓ Photos, only where schools and parents have consented

We will document the recognition delivered and report the results we have. Audience reach and commercial outcomes are not guaranteed. Student contact details are not shared.

POSSIBLE LATER, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

A showcase slot for top Hack876 Resilience builds at a future Climate Action Conference and Expo.

Inviting Power Up Energy Club members from Hack876 schools to apply.

A hands-on energy hardware table, in the spirit of the Foundation's robotics and electric car sessions.

Sharing Power Up Scholarship information with Hack876 finalists heading to university.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

**A conversation about whether the Foundation would consider supporting the inaugural event, at Gold or any other level, and how it prefers to receive a request. A detailed budget will follow before any formal commitment.**

The Foundation's mission names STEM Education and partnership as two of the ways it works.[2]

**Your contact:** Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com · Book a call: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

**We would love to explore the right first step with Sophia and the JPS Foundation team.**

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

**Many participants are minors. There is no marketing aimed at students, and no student contact details or data are shared with sponsors.**

**Any hardware or electrical build is supervised by a qualified adult, with safe, low-voltage kits only.**

**Judging stays independent. A sponsored award is decided by the full judging panel against the published criteria.**

05 APPENDIX

# Contribution levels, and what each receives.

### Bronze Partner

**J$50,000 to below J$200,000**

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

### Silver Partner

**J$200,000 to below J$500,000**

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

### Gold Partner

**J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000**

OUR SUGGESTION

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement on the website and event signage
- A dedicated sponsor feature**
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

### Platinum Partner

**J$1,000,000+**

- Everything in Gold
- The most prominent placement on the website and event signage

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

**The form of the sponsor feature is agreed with each Gold or Platinum partner before it is confirmed.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

**In-kind & Community Support:** For contributions in kind, and for contributions below J$50,000. A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

SOURCES


**1.** Jamaica Gleaner, "Built For success: Aspiring civil and medical engineer among JPS Foundation scholars (August 22, 2026)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20260822/built-success-aspiring-civil-and-medical-engineer-among-jps-foundation

**2.** JPS Foundation, "2024 Annual Report." www.jpsco.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/JPSF_2024-ANNUAL-REPORT_WEB.pdf

**3.** Jamaica Observer, "JPS Foundation covers industrial technology CSEC exam fee for over 300 students (April 23, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/04/23/jps-foundation-covers-industrial-technology-csec-exam-fee-300-students/

**4.** Jamaica Observer, "JPS Foundation's climate conference urges youth to drive Jamaica's road to resilience (March 26, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/03/26/jps-foundations-climate-conference-urges-youth-drive-jamaicas-road-resilience/

**5.** Jamaica Gleaner, "JPS Foundation, UWI workshop benefits CAPE/STEM students islandwide (January 19, 2026)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20260119/jps-foundation-uwi-workshop-benefits-capestem-students-islandwide

**6.** Jamaica Gleaner, "Students, stakeholders drive climate solutions at JPS Expo (March 28, 2026)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20260328/students-stakeholders-drive-climate-solutions-jps-expo


A private partnership proposal prepared for Sophia Lewis, Head, JPS Foundation.